INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

BUSINESS FINANCE SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Accurate – Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Discuss opportunities for building professional relationships in finance.
2. Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals.
3. Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.
4. Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.
5. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a commercial lending associate at MAPLE RIDGE COMMUNITY BANK. You were hired three months ago. The vice president of commercial lending (judge) wants you to explain how you will help the department meet its growth goal.

MAPLE RIDGE has $48 million in small-business loans. The bank's goal is to grow that amount by 15% next year. The goal is split evenly among four lending team members, including you. Past results show:

- The average small-business loan is $150,000.
- About 1 in 4 qualified referrals becomes a closed loan.

Most of MAPLE RIDGE's business loans come from referrals by accountants, attorneys, real estate agents and the local chamber of commerce. You don't yet know anyone in the local business community. The bank will pay for a chamber of commerce membership and one industry training program for you this year.

The vice president (judge) wants you to:

- Calculate your share of the growth goal, how many loans you need to close and how many referrals you need each month.
- Explain how you will build professional relationships to generate referrals.
- Explain how to change your communication style for business owners and for referral partners.
- Identify skills you need to develop and resources that can help.

You will present your plan to the vice president (judge) in a meeting in the vice president's office. The vice president (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your plan. After you have presented your plan and answered the vice president's (judge's) questions, the vice president (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why would an accountant send their clients to you instead of a bigger bank?
2. How would you talk differently to a bakery owner than to a CPA who might refer clients to us?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Discuss opportunities for building professional relationships in finance.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Accurate** Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	

Answer key:

- Growth goal: 15% × $48 million = $7.2 million.
- Your share: $7.2 million ÷ 4 = $1.8 million.
- Loans needed: $1.8 million ÷ $150,000 = 12 loans.
- Referrals needed: 12 × 4 = 48 qualified referrals per year, or 4 per month.